



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: The Classical Christian Academy at Bethel
School Website: <https://tcca.life>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

The Classical Christian Academy Bethel WV 25403 (TCCA), as represented in the school's public materials, presents a classical Christian model that emphasizes formation, virtue, and a faith-integrated curriculum anchored by the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Quadrivium alongside Great Books and a biblical worldview. The school explicitly frames its mission around formation of character, truth, goodness, and beauty, with Christ-centered instruction, biblical literacy, and a farm/experiential component that ties learning to creation and stewardship. These signals align strongly with classical education principles in several categories, particularly in Religious and Metaphysical Foundations, Curriculum, and School Purpose & Goal. Evidence shows a clear emphasis on virtue, truth, and beauty, a robust Christian theological framing, and a curriculum designed around liberal arts and Great Books rather than secular or vocational preoccupations. Some aspects—especially the Pedagogy and Faculty categories—are less explicit in the public materials, which yields a more nuanced assessment in those areas.

Aggregate classification based on the six-category rubric: **CLASSICAL**, with some categories strongly **CLASSICAL** (e.g., Religion/Metaphysical Foundations, Curriculum, and School Purpose & Goal) and a few categories showing partial but substantial classical alignment (Pedagogy and Faculty). This assessment uses keyword signals from the classical rubric and public content from the school's materials.

- Evidence highlights include explicit theological grounding and biblical literacy, a Trivium/Quadrivium framework, Great Books emphasis, and formation-focused language. See statements of faith, biblical literacy, and Trivium/Quadrivium references, as well as the "What Sets Us Apart" and "Curriculum" sections.
- Positive classical indicators (truth, goodness, beauty; formation; Great Books; Trivium/Quadrivium; liturgical/communal elements) are present in multiple public materials.
- A few areas (notably explicit pedagogy terms like Socratic seminars in the public pages) are less visible in the crawl, contributing to a cautious but favorable overall reading. Where explicit pedagogical terminology is absent, the school's classical approach is still strongly implied by the presence of Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books, and formation language.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **CLASSICAL**

Evidence - The school presents a formal Christian identity, including a Statement of Faith that proclaims Christian orthodoxy and the Bible as God's Word. This anchors theology as a foundational discipline. - Biblical literacy is a stated curricular focus, with daily bible study and Scripture immersion referenced in the curriculum. - The curriculum presents faith-integrated learning (Bible, Christ-centered learning) and references to creation, God, and Christian formation in the public materials.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators drawn from the Six Essential Elements lexicon include truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; theology; liturgy; worship; reverence; wonder; divine order. The school's materials explicitly mention truth, beauty, virtue through statements like "We nurture hearts that love what is good, true, and beautiful" and "Biblical Literacy" in a Christ-centered framework, aligning with transcendentals and moral formation. - No clear negative signals from the school materials in this domain (no explicit secular-relativist or values-neutral language detected in the public materials provided).

Why this rating - The school explicitly anchors education in Christian theology and Biblical worldview, with explicit articulation of truth, virtue, and beauty as real and knowable. The presence of a formal statement of faith and Biblical literacy situates this category firmly within the Classical tradition's religious/metaphysical foundations.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission emphasizes formation of character and wisdom, not vocational training alone; language emphasizes a formation-centered aims (e.g., "formation rather than information," "virtue," and "human flourishing"). The not-just-another-school framing highlights faith-based formation and real-world experiences. - Great Books, liberal arts emphasis, and formation through the Trivium/Quadrivium appear as core scaffolds for lifelong learning and moral formation. - The curriculum highlights a Christ-centered, timeless education aimed at moral character, discernment, and wisdom rather than just workforce preparation. - The public materials explicitly connect education to virtue and moral formation (e.g., "Truth & Virtue," "We nurture hearts that love what is good, true, and beautiful").

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators include formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, telos, and great conversation; the public materials reflect formation-oriented aims and the pursuit of true, good, beautiful. - Negative indicators: none clearly evident in the public materials; no explicit emphasis on college or career readiness as the primary telos. The materials repeatedly emphasize formation and virtue over job-training language.

Why this rating - The school frames education as formation toward virtue and wisdom with a transcendent telos (truth, goodness, beauty), aligning with the classical goal of forming human excellence rather than merely preparing for work. The presence of Great Books and liberal arts undergirds this as CLASSICAL.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Core curriculum emphasizes the liberal arts with explicit Trivium and Quadrivium structure. The school describes grammar, logic, rhetoric as foundational, and integrates history throughout the curriculum. - Great Books and primary sources are highlighted as part of the curriculum, describing a "Great Conversation" approach to Western civilization. - The curriculum includes Bible, literature, history, mathematics, science, Latin, and agriculture, indicating a broad liberal-arts core rather than a narrow or skills-based curriculum. - The school presents a living integration of faith and learning (e.g., daily agriculture, hands-on experiences) that connects subject matter to larger questions and wonder.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators in the lexicon include Seven Liberal Arts (Trivium/Quadrivium), Great Books, Latin, history, and interdisciplinary/harmonic approaches. The school's content directly references Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books, Latin, and integrated history. - No explicit negative signals about curriculum structure are evident in the public materials; the materials align with classical curriculum signals rather than social-studies-first, STEM-dominant, or other modern deviations.

Why this rating - The explicit grounding in the Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books, Latin, and integrated history, plus a curriculum described as Christ-centered and liberal-arts oriented, satisfies the Curriculum criteria for CLASSICAL.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize a classical approach to learning, including the Trivium and Great Books, and a real-world experiential component (agriculture, 4-H, outdoor learning) that anchors memory, virtue, and practical understanding. - The public materials suggest a blend of structured classical pedagogy with experiential elements but do not consistently spell out explicit classroom practices like Socratic seminars or scholé days in the visible site content. Some elements of contemplative/restful learning are alluded to in the broader classical framework, but concrete implementation details (e.g., regular Socratic discussions, chanting, formal memory work) are not consistently explicit in the crawl.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords from the lexicon include Socratic dialogue, dialectic, narration/recitation, scholé (restful learning), seminars, rhetoric, memory work, and liturgical/choral practices. While the Trivium/Quadrivium and Great Books signals are strong positives, explicit references to Socratic seminars, ritual chanting, or formal memory exercises are not consistently visible in the crawl content. This yields a partial CLASSICAL signal. - Negative indicators (as per the lexicon) would include over-reliance on project-based learning alone or constructivist-only approaches without classical scaffolding. The public content does not foreground project-based dominance to the exclusion of classical methods, but explicit pedagogy language is not always present.

Why this rating - The school clearly embraces classical content (Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books, Latin) and formation-oriented aims, but the crawl does not consistently present a complete set of explicit pedagogy practices (e.g., explicit Socratic seminars, scholé days) in the public materials. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating rather than full CLASSICAL, given the partial exposure of explicit pedagogy signals.

Element 5: Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials emphasize teachers as facilitators and moral exemplars, with references to virtue, character, and lifelong learning. Some content invokes a sense of the faculty as living curriculum (e.g., the emphasis on formation, virtue, and a character-focused environment). The public materials also highlight a mission-driven staff and a culture of faith, with the Knights symbol and Statement of Faith. - However, explicit statements about a formal “faculty as living curriculum” portrait, or clearly defined faculty profiles, or a “faculty of friends” culture, are less visible in the crawl. The public content includes admissions and program references but fewer explicit faculty portraits or a formal faculty-development narrative.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords from the lexicon include model teachers/mentors, living curriculum, portrait of teacher/student, and collegial culture. The public materials imply a virtuous, faith-centered staff ethos (e.g., Statement of Faith and “truth & virtue” framing). - Negative keywords (from the lexicon) would be: superficial or secular staff development, non-classical jargon, or credentials-driven only without classical context. The crawl content does not strongly exhibit those negative signals, but explicit articulation of a living-curriculum faculty profile is not uniformly visible.

Why this rating - The school’s materials strongly align with the ethos and formation-focused vision described in classical frameworks, but the public crawl provides less explicit, detailed faculty-culture descriptors. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Faculty.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL (with strong signals)

Evidence - The school presents a partnership with families and parental involvement as integral to classical education, including parent formation and community engagement through book studies and gatherings; it invites parents to visit. The site materials emphasize a family-centered formation and parental partnership, aligning with classical expectations of parent-teacher collaboration and home-school synergy. - The school’s public materials explicitly promote a cooperative relationship with parents and community, including involvement in classical education through the school and home dynamics (e.g., “partnership with families,” “parent formation,” and open-campus hospitality). - There are direct mentions of community-building signals (e.g., school events and engagement with families) supported by the family-formation lexicon signals in the Six Essentials framework.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators include partnership with families, parent formation, open campus, and home-centered learning. The school's materials show explicit emphasis on parental involvement and family engagement. - Negative signals: none evident in the crawl regarding parental involvement; no consumer-language framing or minimal parental involvement signals appear.

Why this rating - The school presents robust signals of parent partnership and community involvement, which aligns with the classical element of Parents & Community.

What Would Move the Needle

- **Pedagogy:** If the school more explicitly documents and standardizes classical pedagogy practices (e.g., regular Socratic seminars, scholé days, memory-work routines, and chanting in appropriate lower/upper school contexts) in public materials, the Pedagogy category would reach CLASSICAL. Concrete examples: publish a pedagogy guide detailing how Trivium/Quadrivium are implemented daily, include sample freshmen/seminar formats, and outline memory-work sequences and chant-based practices.
- **Faculty:** Develop and publish a formal "living curriculum" portrait of the teacher-student role, with faculty profiles and a documented professional-growth plan aligned with classical formation. This would strengthen Element 5 to CLASSICAL.
- **Curriculum:** Maintain and strengthen the explicit Great Books program and ensure a publicly available scope-and-sequence showing the Great Conversation across grades, with regular shared reading and discussion protocols. This would reinforce Element 3 as CLASSICAL.
- **Community:** Expand parent-formation programming (e.g., classical book clubs, parent-study series, and family liturgy resources) with public calendars and summaries to further anchor Element 6 as CLASSICAL.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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